CLI GUIDE

HYPERCLUSTER CLI GUIDE

Task-oriented reference for the bash CLI. Generated CLI help is also at docs/_build/cli-reference.txt (run make docs).

Quick paths

Goal · Commands
Remote k3s platform · preflight ? deploy ? test
Kubespray HA cluster · wizard or edit conf ? preflight ? deploy
Automation / CI · preflight --json, test --json, status --json
Desktop / inventory · discover --json, vms --json, workloads --json
Day-2 add nodes · Update WORKER_IPS ? scale
Upgrade K8s · Bump KUBE_VERSION ? upgrade

Global flags

Flag · Meaning
-c <file> · Config file (default ./cluster.conf)
-f · Force inventory regen; skip destroy confirm; force remove-node
-n · Dry run
-v · Verbose Ansible output
-V · Print version
-h · Help

Commands

Command · k3s · Kubespray · Description
wizard · ? · ? · Interactive cluster.conf generator
init --profile <name> · ? · ? · Copy config/profiles/<name>.conf.example ? cluster.conf
init · ? · ? · Clone Kubespray + inventory
preflight · ? · ? · Local tools + SSH checks
preflight --json · ? · ? · Machine-readable preflight JSON
deploy · ? · ? · Full install
test · ? · ? · Platform smoke tests
test --full · ? · ? · Extended snapshot checks
test --json · ? · ? · Machine-readable results
status · ? · ? · Node status
status --json · ? · ? · Machine-readable node JSON
discover --json · ? · ? · Discover hosts/VMs (no config required)
vms --json · ? · ? · KubeVirt VMIs + template catalog
vm create --json · ? · ? · Validate template; create stub (preview)
workloads --json · ? · ? · Pod and service inventory
scale · partial · ? · Add workers from conf

upgrade · ? · ? · Upgrade to KUBE_VERSION
remove-node · ? · ? · Drain + remove node
fetch-kubeconfig · ? · ? · Copy admin kubeconfig
merge-kubeconfig · ? · ? · Merge into ~/.kube/config
install-kubevirt · ? · ? · KubeVirt + CDI
destroy · ? · ? · Tear down cluster
unlock · ? · ? · Clear stale lock

k3s platform workflow

cp config/cluster.conf.example cluster.conf
 # or:

```
./hypercluster init --profile k3s-remote
```

$EDITOR cluster.conf # K8S_DISTRO=k3s, METALLB_IP_POOL, SSH_*, CONTROL_PLANE_IPS

```
./hypercluster -c cluster.conf preflight
./hypercluster -c cluster.conf preflight --json
./hypercluster -c cluster.conf deploy
./hypercluster -c cluster.conf test
./hypercluster -c cluster.conf status --json
./hypercluster -c cluster.conf workloads --json
```

Deploy behavior: skips k3s reinstall when server is healthy. Set FORCE_K3S_REINSTALL=1 to replace.
Stack order: Cilium ? cert-manager ? MetalLB ? KubeVirt/CDI ? metrics-server.
Per-node SSH (k3s): set NODE_SSH_OVERRIDES_JSON to a JSON array of {ip, sshUser?, sshKey?, sshPort?} objects when nodes need different credentials than global SSH_*.

Discover (no cluster.conf)

CSV fixture (unit test / import preview)

```
./hypercluster discover --json --source csv --csv tests/fixtures/discover-nodes.csv
```

Other sources: libvirt, proxmox, vmware, ssh-scan (see lib/discover.sh)

```
./hypercluster discover --json --source libvirt --uri qemu:///system
```

JSON output

`test --json`:
Stdout (stderr has human PASS/FAIL lines):

{"pass": 10, "fail": 0, "checks": [{"name": "Cilium healthy", "passed": true}]}

`status --json`:

{"ready": 1, "total": 1, "nodes": [{"name": "node1", "ready": true, "roles": "true"}]}

`workloads --json`:

{"pods": [{"namespace": "kube-system", "name": "cilium-abc", "phase": "Running", "node": "10.0.0.10", "ready": 1, "containers": 1}], "services": [{"namespace": "default", "name": "kubernetes", "type": "ClusterIP", "clusterIp": "10.43.0.1"}]}

`vms --json`:

{"vms": [], "templates": [{"id": "ubuntu-22.04", "label": "Ubuntu 22.04 LTS", "os": "linux"}]}

`vm create --json`:

{"status": "stub", "message": "VM create from template is not yet implemented ? catalog entry validated", "template": {}, "name": "my-vm", "namespace": "default"}

Make shortcuts

```
make deploy CONFIG=cluster.conf
make test-remote CONFIG=cluster.conf
make status CONFIG=cluster.conf
make desktop-check    # TS build + discover/vms/workloads JSON tests
make docs
```

See docs/generated/MAKE-TARGETS.md for full list.

Related

- Desktop UX guide
- Configuration reference
- Documentation hub

Doc version: 2026-06-06T14:21:14Z · hypercluster v0.1.0